# Atlanta, GA

## Strategic IT Landscape and Market Analysis Report

March 31, 2026

# 1. Executive Summary & Macro Landscape

The City of Atlanta, Georgia, operates as the premier economic engine and technological nexus of the Southeastern United States. Characterized by a remarkably robust fiscal posture, the municipality recently achieved a historic AAA bond rating, an upgrade that underscores highly disciplined financial management and creates a highly favorable climate for large-scale infrastructure and technology investments.[1] Operating under the executive leadership of Mayor Andre Dickens, the city is navigating a period of intense demographic and economic growth. Recent population estimates indicate that the Atlanta region added over 64,400 residents in a single year, with the city proper accounting for a significant share of that urban influx.[2] To manage this expansion, the municipal government administers an operating budget that approached $2.75 billion for Fiscal Year (FY) 2025 [3], with the proposed FY2026 budget expanding further to an unprecedented $3 billion, alongside a staggering $9.3 billion in anticipated capital funding.[5]

Atlanta's strategic trajectory is fundamentally shaped by the "Moving Atlanta Forward" agenda, an ambitious administrative framework supported by a voter-approved $750 million infrastructure package.[6] This massive capital injection is designed to simultaneously address the pressures of rapid urbanization, modernize aging legacy infrastructure, and execute an urgent mandate to digitize constituent services. Short-term catalysts, such as the upcoming 2026 FIFA World Cup, are also driving immediate capital releases for edge computing, Wi-Fi expansion, and public safety sensor networks. The broader macroeconomic environment surrounding the city further amplifies its technological importance; the metropolitan Atlanta area has evolved into a primary node on North America's digital infrastructure map, experiencing an annual data center net absorption of 705.8 MW—outpacing even Northern Virginia.[8] This regional explosion of artificial intelligence (AI) workloads, dark-fiber grids, and hyperscale operations directly pressures the municipal government to modernize its own enterprise architecture to compete for talent, protect critical infrastructure, and deliver intelligent civic services.

For enterprise technology vendors, particularly Dell Technologies, the City of Atlanta represents a high-yield, complex target market. The municipal technology landscape is characterized by well-funded mandates for AI adoption, extensive edge computing deployments to support public safety, and a persistent need for data center and storage modernization. The administration's strategic operations are driven by core administrative goals that dictate the flow of appropriations and the prioritization of IT procurement.

| Core Administrative Goal | Strategic Objective & Investment Focus | Alignment with Technology Modernization |
|---|---|---|
| **Public Safety & Civic Resilience ("One Safe City")** | A comprehensive approach combining law enforcement modernization with non-policing alternatives. The initiative has successfully reduced homicides by 26% since 2022. The administration recently allocated $29.8 million specifically for security equipment and technology upgrades.[1] | Drives massive procurement of edge computing devices, high-capacity video surveillance storage, automated license plate readers (ALPR), and CJIS-compliant network infrastructure.[4] |
| **Digital Equity & Smart City Innovation** | Recognized as a top-ranking smart city in North America, Atlanta is rapidly expanding its Internet of Things (IoT) footprint and energy-efficient infrastructure. A prime example is the "Light Up the Night" initiative, which deployed 30,000 smart LED streetlights to improve safety and connectivity.[1] | Requires ruggedized edge servers, centralized data orchestration platforms, and high-throughput data lakes to ingest and analyze continuous telemetry from distributed civic assets.[12] |
| **Economic Development & Affordable Housing** | The administration is aggressively pursuing the construction and preservation of 20,000 affordable housing units (with over 11,000 already completed), underpinned by rapid rehousing programs and neighborhood stabilization funds targeting legacy residents and marginalized communities.[6] | Relies heavily on modernized geographic information systems (GIS), automated permitting workflows, and data-sharing across housing authorities and enterprise asset management databases.[14] |
| **Ethical Government & Process Modernization** | Driven by a projected $33 million budget deficit pressure in the general fund, the city is heavily focused on operational efficiency. The goal is to eliminate manual administrative friction, optimize route planning for public works, and improve the ATL311 constituent service portal.[16] | Catalyzes the transition toward generative AI (GenAI), enterprise resource planning (ERP) cloud repatriation, and the elimination of "shadow IT" localized tracking spreadsheets.[17] |

## 2. Power Structure & Key Stakeholders

Understanding the complex nexus of political intent and technical execution is critical for navigating the City of Atlanta's procurement landscape. The power structure is strictly bifurcated into two primary spheres: elected officials who control the appropriations, tax levies, and strategic mandates, and the technical leadership responsible for architectural standards, vendor evaluation, and system implementation. Procurement success requires alignment with both the financial purchasers who demand civic return on investment (ROI) and the technical influencers who demand performance, security, and interoperability.

| Name & Title | Sphere of Influence | Recent Public Stances on Technology |
|---|---|---|
| **Andre Dickens**, Mayor | Financial Purchaser & Executive Mandate | Champions the "One Safe City" and "Moving Atlanta Forward" initiatives. Highly supportive of leveraging technology to drive economic equity. Explicitly praised the use of AI technology to proactively detect and address issues within the city's aging water system.[1] |
| **Howard Shook**, City Council Member | Financial Purchaser (Appropriations) | Serves as the Chair of the powerful Finance/Executive Committee, which has direct legislative jurisdiction over the Department of Atlanta Information Management (AIM) and total budget approvals.[21] |
| **Alex Wan**, City Council Member | Financial Purchaser (Appropriations) | Vice Chair of the Finance/Executive Committee. Instrumental in scrutinizing departmental operating budgets, capital expenditures, and tracking the financial efficacy of municipal software implementations.[21] |
| **Amir Farokhi**, City Council Member | Policy Influencer & Legislative Driver | Spearheaded the legislation to create the Atlanta Artificial Intelligence Commission. Publicly advocates for using AI to streamline administrative tasks and improve customer service, explicitly noting its necessity during lean fiscal years.[17] |

| Name & Title | Sphere of Influence | Recent Public Stances on Technology |
|---|---|---|
| **Jason Sankey**, Chief Information Officer | Technical Purchaser & Architectural Authority | Leads the Department of Atlanta Information Management (AIM). Appointed to the AI Commission. Views technology as the "nucleus of city government." Focuses on application modernization, strengthening core infrastructure, and delivering user-focused, reliable solutions.[24] |
| **Donald Graham**, Chief Information Security Officer | Technical Influencer & Compliance Gatekeeper | Focuses on cyber resilience, identity management, and securing the city's perimeter against ransomware and insider threats. Regularly participates in regional cybersecurity policy roundtables to shape SLG security standards.[29] |
| **Tameka Neely-Dudley**, IT Director | Technical Influencer (Agency Level) | Serves as an agency-level Information Technology Director. Focuses on aligning specific departmental technology priorities with broader city data governance, workforce development, and cybersecurity frameworks.[30] |
| **Nikhil Deshpande**, Chief Digital & AI Officer (State of GA) | Strategic Influencer & Policy Alignment | While a State of Georgia official, he sits on the Atlanta AI Commission. Instrumental in shaping how local governments interact with state AI frameworks, GenAI sandboxes, and ethical data usage protocols.[23] |
| **Zaffer Sange**, Chief Strategy Officer | Strategic Alignment | Operates within the Mayor's Cabinet. Responsible for aligning departmental execution with the Mayor's overarching policy goals, ensuring that IT investments map directly to civic outcomes.[31] |

# 3. IT Governance & Service Delivery Model

The City of Atlanta's approach to technology governance is designed to balance the need for enterprise-wide standardization with the unique, high-availability operational complexities of its massive, revenue-generating utilities. The resulting organizational structure presents both centralized procurement opportunities and decentralized sales avenues depending on the target agency.

## Operating Model: Hybrid-Federated

The City of Atlanta strictly employs a **Hybrid-Federated IT delivery model.**[27] At the center of this model is the Department of Atlanta Information Management (AIM), led by CIO Jason Sankey. AIM serves as the central nervous system for the city, consolidating and providing core IT services, network infrastructure, enterprise cybersecurity, and project management governance for all "General Fund" departments.[21] This includes centralized support for critical public safety agencies (Atlanta Police Department, Atlanta Fire Rescue, Corrections), the Department of Public Works, the Department of Transportation (ATLDOT), and the Municipal Courts.[27] For these agencies, AIM dictates the architectural standards, manages the Microsoft environments, and controls the primary data center footprint.

However, a strict federated exception exists for the city's largest "Enterprise Funds." Because these departments function as self-sustaining businesses funded by user fees and distinct bond structures, they operate with significant technological autonomy:

- **The Department of Aviation:** Manages Hartsfield-Jackson Atlanta International Airport, the busiest airport in the world. Due to the extreme breadth and complexity of airport operations, FAA regulations, and specialized operational technology (OT), Aviation maintains a completely separate IT budget and dedicated telecommunications infrastructure.[27] To support operations, the airport is actively transitioning to a modern data lakehouse architecture to ingest massive amounts of IoT sensor data for predictive analytics, such as demand forecasting, optimizing gate utilization, and tracking wait times. Furthermore, the City Council approved a new Distributed Antenna System (DAS) to upgrade the airport's wireless infrastructure to 5G, scheduled for completion in January 2026.
- **The Department of Watershed Management (DWM):** Serving 1.2 million customers daily, DWM manages drinking water, wastewater, and stormwater systems.[32] Like Aviation, DWM operates a separate IT budget to manage its massive deployment of geographic information systems (GIS), SCADA (Supervisory Control and Data Acquisition) networks, and smart water meters.[27]

While AIM establishes baseline enterprise standards, these federated enterprise departments execute independent procurements for infrastructure, edge compute, and storage, making them distinct sales territories within the broader municipal umbrella.[27]

## Chargeback Models & Operational Friction Points

The City of Atlanta operates an **Internal Service Fund** accounting model to distribute the costs of centralized AIM services back to the individual departments that consume them.[27] Specifically, the "Office Services Internal Service Fund" is utilized to manage the chargeback system for software licenses, personal computers, storage consumption, and telecommunications. Departments are billed based on their actual expenditures and resource utilization, requiring routine journal entries by the Finance Department to recognize these chargebacks and balance the internal ledgers.[34]

**Operational Friction Points & Shadow IT Risks:** The chargeback model, while fiscally responsible, creates severe operational friction. Because departments are billed for the services they consume from AIM, there is a constant temptation for agency leaders to bypass centralized IT to avoid internal "soft costs" (which include project management fees, centralized software licensing, and administrative overhead).[19]

This friction was starkly illuminated in a recent performance audit conducted by the City Auditor regarding the $750 million "Moving Atlanta Forward" infrastructure program.[19] The audit revealed profound vulnerabilities in how IT and administrative costs are tracked across different executing agencies:

- **Decentralized Tracking Failures:** While the Department of Transportation (ATLDOT) utilizes a dedicated finance division to track time and project costs, the **Department of Parks and Recreation (DPR)** was found to be operating almost entirely outside of the city's enterprise Oracle financial software for capital project tracking.[19]
- **The Rise of Shadow IT:** To manage its portion of the infrastructure projects, DPR was found to be manually tracking and monitoring all financial data via localized, disconnected Excel spreadsheets.[19] This classic manifestation of "shadow IT" bypasses AIM's governance, creates massive data silos, and introduces an extreme risk of human error and budget overruns.
- **Dashboard Inaccuracies:** The city's centralized public-facing data dashboard for the Moving Atlanta Forward program was found to contain inaccurate data specifically because these disparate, manual reporting mechanisms fail to feed accurate, real-time telemetry back into the central system.[19]

This gap between centralized AIM mandates and decentralized agency practices represents a critical friction point. The city is currently attempting to force departments like DPR to transition to the Oracle PnG module or unified platforms like e-Builder.[19] For an enterprise vendor, this friction highlights an urgent requirement for unified data management platforms, automated orchestration, and predictable OpEx consumption models (like Dell APEX) that can eliminate the billing disputes and shadow IT sprawl inherent in the city's current chargeback methodology.

# 4. Financials & Budget Breakdown

Atlanta's financial apparatus is complex and heavily capitalized, characterized by aggressive infrastructure spending and a highly strategic pursuit of federal grant funding to subsidize technological modernization. The city operates on a fiscal year that runs from July 1 through June 30.[3] Peak procurement activity, budget reconciliation, and surplus depletion typically occur in the fourth quarter (April–June), while major long-term technology planning is mapped across a rolling 5-year Capital Improvement Plan (CIP).[35]

## Total & IT Budget

- **City-Wide Operating Budget:** The Atlanta City Council unanimously adopted an annual operating budget of approximately **$2.75 billion for FY2025**.[3] Looking ahead, the administration's proposed FY2026 budget outlines a massive $3 billion operating plan. Within this, the General Fund comprises $975.4 million—a robust 14% increase over the FY2025 adopted budget.[5]
- **Capital Improvement Funding:** Beyond the operating budget, the proposed FY2026 framework identifies an astounding **$9.3 billion in long-term capital funding** necessary to support Atlanta's residents, infrastructure, and utility networks over the coming years.[5] Furthermore, in late 2024, the City Council adopted an additional $120 million bond package specifically to fund roadway and infrastructure improvements in Downtown ahead of the 2026 FIFA World Cup, creating immediate, short-term project influxes.[36] Most recently, in March 2026, the City Council approved funding specifically for the "Integrated Atlanta: Wi-Fi World Cup Initiative," allocating hundreds of thousands of dollars for smart streetlight infrastructure and Wi-Fi expansion via Georgia Power and Comcast.
- **AIM IT Operating Budget:** The Department of Atlanta Information Management (AIM) was allocated a proposed operating budget of **$43,032,442 for FY2025**.[21] This represents a 3.7% year-over-year increase ($1.6 million) from FY2024. Interestingly, the number of authorized IT positions was proposed to decrease from 154 to 149 (a 3.2% reduction).[21] This inverse relationship—more operational funding but fewer internal staff—indicates that AIM is increasingly reliant on outsourced managed services, SaaS subscriptions, and vendor-led automation to bridge the human capital gap.
- **O&M vs. Capital Splitting:** The $43 million AIM budget primarily covers recurring Operational and Maintenance (O&M) spend, enterprise software licensing (such as the recent $3.5 million Microsoft Unified Support Services contract [37]), and personnel. *Specific line-item delineations for exact server/storage capital refreshes within the $43M baseline are Data Unavailable*. However, net-new capitalized infrastructure projects—such as new data center build-outs or massive network expansions—are typically funded through the $750 million Moving Atlanta Forward infrastructure bond or specific agency capital outlays, rather than the baseline AIM operating budget.[6]

## Grants & Federal Funding Influxes

The City of Atlanta, in coordination with the State of Georgia, is aggressively positioning itself to absorb federal funding to underwrite its technology and security modernization efforts. These funds act as multipliers for Dell's addressable market.

| Funding Source | Total Value & Allocation Mechanism | Applicability to Technology Modernization |
|---|---|---|
| **State and Local Cybersecurity Grant Program (SLCGP)** | Supported by the federal Infrastructure Investment and Jobs Act (IIJA), the State of Georgia was allocated approximately **$7.59 million for FY2024**.[38] The federal mandate requires that at least 70% of these funds pass through to local governments like Atlanta.[38] Recently, the Georgia Emergency Management and Homeland Security Agency (GEMA/HS) released nearly $10 million in accumulated SLCGP awards to 44 local entities.[39] | These funds are strictly earmarked for modernizing IT systems, deploying zero-trust architectures, migrating off end-of-life infrastructure, and training staff against ransomware and phishing threats.[38] |
| **NTIA BEAD Program & Digital Equity** | The Georgia Technology Authority (GTA) is managing over **$300 million** in National Telecommunications and Information Administration (NTIA) Broadband Equity, Access, and Deployment (BEAD) funds.[41] | While primarily for broadband expansion, these funds support digital connectivity plans, public Wi-Fi access, and smart city infrastructure that directly requires robust edge computing and routing hardware.[41] |
| **IIJA & ARPA Transportation Grants** | The city is utilizing millions in American Rescue Plan Act (ARPA) and IIJA funding to modernize transportation corridors. Recently, the city allocated over $6 million in ARPA funds specifically for sidewalk connections and neighborhood centers.[7] | Transportation modernization inherently requires substantial investments in smart city infrastructure, IoT traffic sensors, ALPR cameras, and the localized edge computing necessary to process transit data.[42] |

# 5. Strategic Initiatives & Projects

Based on legislative mandates, capital allocations, and public executive directives, the following represent the top funded modernization efforts currently underway within the City of Atlanta. Each initiative presents profound underlying IT requirements that align with enterprise technology portfolios.

## Initiative 1: The Atlanta Artificial Intelligence Commission & Civic AI Integration

- **The Executive Mandate:** Driven by Mayor Andre Dickens and championed by Councilmember Amir Farokhi, the city unanimously passed legislation to establish a 13-member Artificial Intelligence Commission.[17] The mandate is to explore how GenAI and machine learning can streamline administrative inefficiencies, offset a projected $33 million general fund deficit, and radically improve constituent interactions via the ATL.Direct newsroom and ATL311 portal.[17] The commission held its first meeting in May 2025 and convened on February 18, 2026, to finalize its strategic roadmap and policy mandates.
- **High-Spend Agency Owner:** The Department of Atlanta Information Management (AIM), operating in close strategic coordination with the State's Georgia Technology Authority (GTA), which oversees the state-level GenAI Sandbox initiatives and ethical AI governance frameworks.[23]
- **The Underlying IT Requirement: AI-Ready Infrastructure and High-Performance Compute.** The city cannot rely solely on public cloud LLMs due to data sovereignty, CJIS compliance, and citizen privacy concerns. They require scalable, GPU-dense compute clusters and localized hosting environments. More importantly, before AI can be effectively deployed, the city must solve its unstructured data problem, requiring high-performance data lake architectures to ingest, clean, and govern municipal data silos so they can be safely queried by machine learning models.

## Initiative 2: "One Safe City," the 2026 World Cup, and Smart Infrastructure Expansion

- **The Executive Mandate:** A defining cornerstone of the Dickens administration, the "One Safe City" initiative seeks to leverage advanced technology to reduce crime, optimize emergency response times, and achieve "Vision Zero" traffic safety goals.[1] This has been heavily accelerated by preparations for the 2026 FIFA World Cup. In March 2026, the City Council approved the "Integrated Atlanta: Wi-Fi World Cup Initiative," deploying over $660,000 in immediate contracts to Georgia Power and Comcast for smart streetlights and expanded connectivity.
- **High-Spend Agency Owner:** The Atlanta Police Department (APD), Atlanta Fire Rescue Department (AFRD), and the Atlanta Department of Transportation (ATLDOT).[6]
- **The Underlying IT Requirement: Edge Computing, Video Storage, and Cyber**

**Resilience.** APD and ATLDOT are rapidly deploying thousands of IoT sensors, automated license plate readers, and smart LED streetlights.[1] The exponential influx of unstructured video and telemetry data requires ruggedized edge computing devices capable of processing video analytics locally to reduce backhaul latency, and massive, scale-out Network Attached Storage (NAS) environments for evidentiary retention. Furthermore, because this data is mission-critical, the entire architecture requires CJIS-compliant data protection to secure endpoints against ransomware.[10]

### Initiative 3: Enterprise Cloud ERP Modernization & Soft-Cost Digitization

- **The Executive Mandate:** The city is under immense pressure from the City Auditor to eradicate manual administrative processes, improve financial auditing transparency, and seamlessly track the expenditures of the $750 million Moving Atlanta Forward capital projects.[19] The mandate is to enforce enterprise-wide use of digital platforms to prevent budget overruns and shadow IT sprawl.
- **High-Spend Agency Owner:** The Department of Finance, the Department of Enterprise Asset Management (DEAM), the Department of Parks and Recreation (DPR), and AIM.[19]
- **The Underlying IT Requirement: Cloud Repatriation, Hybrid Workload Management, and Database Consolidation.** The city is actively utilizing Oracle Cloud ERP, EPM, and HCM environments.[20] However, the audit's revelation that agencies like Parks and Recreation are actively bypassing these enterprise systems in favor of manual Excel spreadsheets indicates a severe adoption failure and data fragmentation issue.[19] The underlying IT requirement is robust, secure, localized data consolidation and application rationalization. The city requires infrastructure that seamlessly bridges on-premises data silos with public cloud Oracle environments, providing hybrid-cloud management tools that make it easier for departments to use the official systems than to rely on shadow IT.

## 6. Procurement, Vendor Landscape, & Compliance

Selling into the City of Atlanta requires navigating a highly structured, risk-averse procurement ecosystem dominated by established integrators, long-term legacy relationships, and powerful cooperative purchasing agreements.

### Procurement Vehicles & Preferred Methods

The city's Department of Procurement, overseen by the Chief Procurement Officer, strictly adheres to competitive bidding protocols but heavily leverages cooperative agreements to bypass lengthy, politically contentious Request for Proposal (RFP) cycles.

- **Primary Vehicles:** The city routinely utilizes **NASPO ValuePoint**, **OMNIA Partners**, **Sourcewell**, and occasionally recognizes **Texas DIR** contracts for rapid hardware and software acquisition.[47]
- **Recent Precedents:** The willingness to use cooperatives for major enterprise purchases

is evident. Recently, the city utilized a State of Georgia cooperative agreement (GA-DOAS MSA) to execute a $3.5 million Microsoft Unified Support Services contract, explicitly overriding and canceling a localized special procurement cycle to ensure operational continuity without a drawn-out bid.[37]

## The Battlefield: Incumbents, Competitors, & Entrenchment

- **The CDW-G Monopoly:** CDW Government (CDW-G) is deeply entrenched in Atlanta's IT supply chain. For the past 14 years, encompassing four consecutive contract cycles, CDW-G has been awarded the city's primary hardware/software sourcing contract, operating as the sole awardee for two of those cycles.[51] Beyond mere fulfillment, CDW-G provides professional IT services for the General Fund agencies and the federated Department of Watershed Management, giving them unprecedented influence over architectural decisions.[51]
- **Compute & Storage Incumbents:** Dell Technologies enjoys a robust existing footprint across Georgia municipalities, with significant past deployments of PowerEdge servers, PowerStore, and VxRail architectures within the region, and specific recent software/ancillary contracts with the city.[54] However, the environment remains highly heterogeneous and fiercely competitive. Hewlett Packard Enterprise (HPE) maintains a strong presence, particularly in server infrastructure, hyperconverged environments, and data fabric solutions like Ezmeral.[57] NetApp has also historically been a preferred vendor for storage area networks (SAN) and file storage across various municipal departments.[61]
- **Network & Security:** Cisco completely dominates the networking and telecommunications layer, supported heavily by specialized integrators like Presidio and DSI Tech, who hold vast SLED contracts for Cisco deployments.[50]

## Compliance & Regulatory Drivers

Any technology solution proposed to the City of Atlanta must clear strict regulatory frameworks, which are frequently utilized by the CISO (Donald Graham) as technical gatekeepers:

- **NIST Cybersecurity Framework:** A December 2025 audit by the City Auditor specifically evaluated AIM's incident response controls and physical security against National Institute of Standards and Technology (NIST) standards, making strict adherence to NIST a baseline for future security procurements and audits.
- **CJIS (Criminal Justice Information Services):** For any infrastructure touching the Atlanta Police Department, municipal courts, or city-wide video surveillance networks, CJIS compliance is absolute. This dictates FIPS 140-2 validated encryption at rest and in transit, strict multi-factor identity access management, and immutable hardware-level audit logging.[10]
- **StateRAMP / FedRAMP:** As the city pushes workloads to the cloud and hybrid environments, vendors must align with StateRAMP authorized infrastructure to ensure

continuous security monitoring and data sovereignty.[66]

- **AI Governance Mandates:** Influenced by the State of Georgia's AI guidelines and the impending strategic roadmap from the Atlanta AI Commission, any infrastructure supporting AI must adhere to strict data privacy, bias mitigation, and zero-trust security frameworks to prevent the exposure of sensitive civic data to public LLMs.[23]

# 7. Actionable Dell Opportunities

Based on the strategic mandates, budgetary influxes, and technological friction points identified within the City of Atlanta, Dell Technologies is uniquely positioned to execute the following high-value sales motions. By aligning the Dell portfolio with the city's political realities, account executives can bypass the standard commodity hardware cycle and position Dell as a transformative strategic partner.

**Funded Alignment: Capitalizing on Edge Deployments and the AI Commission**

- **The Play: Powering the "Integrated Atlanta: Wi-Fi World Cup Initiative."** The March 2026 City Council approval of this initiative demands immediate edge computing and networking deployments to support smart streetlights and Wi-Fi expansion ahead of the games. Dell should aggressively position its ruggedized **Dell Edge Gateways** and **PowerEdge XR** servers directly to ATLDOT and AIM. These solutions can process the massive, decentralized influx of IoT and video data locally, minimizing latency during the high-traffic events.
- **The Play: Position the Dell AI Factory for Municipal Intelligence.** Mayor Dickens and Councilmember Farokhi have mandated the use of AI to offset a $33 million deficit and improve constituent services.[17] Dell must position the **Dell AI Factory with NVIDIA** directly to CIO Jason Sankey and the AI Commission as they execute the recommendations from their February 2026 roadmap meetings. By architecting the foundational, on-premises infrastructure required to host secure, localized LLMs, Dell enables the city to deploy AI safely within its own firewall, maintaining CJIS and HIPAA compliance.

**Whitespace & Advisory: Eradicating Manual Sprawl and Supporting Federated Autonomy**

- **The Play: Scaling Aviation's Data Lakehouse.** With Hartsfield-Jackson Airport transitioning to a modern data lakehouse architecture to ingest IoT telemetry and upgrading to a 5G DAS, their federated IT organization is generating an unprecedented volume of unstructured data. Dell should bypass the central AIM channel and position **PowerScale** directly to the Department of Aviation as the ultimate scale-out NAS repository for their predictive analytics platform, capitalizing on their distinct, highly funded capital budget.
- **The Play: Leverage the Audit Failure for Dell APEX Data Storage Services.** The City Auditor explicitly called out the dangerous use of manual Excel spreadsheets by the Department of Parks and Recreation for tracking soft costs and managing capital project

data.[19] This shadow IT is a direct result of departments attempting to avoid the "Internal Service Fund" chargeback friction created by AIM.[34] Dell can leverage this audit finding to pitch **Dell APEX**. By providing a cloud-like consumption model on-premises, APEX eliminates the massive CapEx hardware friction, makes internal IT billing highly transparent and predictable, and encourages rogue departments to consolidate their data back under AIM's secure governance.

**Competitive Displacement: Attacking the Heterogeneous Storage Footprint and Channel Monopolies**

- **The Play: Disrupt the CDW-G Monopoly via the December 2025 NIST Audit Findings.** While CDW-G holds the primary 14-year sourcing contract [51], Dell must aggressively engage the city's IT leadership directly. The December 2025 City Auditor report on AIM's incident response controls evaluated the city strictly against NIST frameworks. Dell should shape the technical requirements early—proposing **PowerProtect Cyber Recovery** with Dell-patented air-gapped vaulting mechanisms specifically aligned to resolve NIST audit vulnerabilities. Supported by the state's recent $9.8 million SLCGP grant distributions [40], Dell can dictate the bill of materials before it reaches the CDW-G fulfillment channel.
- **The Play: Execute a Rip-and-Replace Campaign Against Aging HPE and NetApp SANs.** With the city pushing heavily toward AI readiness and high-performance computing, their legacy, heterogeneous storage architectures (HPE Ezmeral, legacy NetApp arrays) will bottleneck performance and create management silos.[57] Dell should position **PowerStore Prime** to consolidate these mixed workloads. By leveraging the NASPO ValuePoint cooperative contract [47], Dell can completely bypass complex, drawn-out RFPs and offer the city aggressive trade-in economics to fundamentally refresh their data center floor under a single, unified management pane.

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